

PROPOSAL FOR IMPACT ASSESSMENT OF GRAM PANCHAYATs – VILLAGE SOCIAL TRANSFORMATION FOUNDATION (VSTF)



Quality Council of India

(An autonomous body set up by
Ministry of Commerce & Industry, Govt. of India)

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1. CONTEXT

- 1.1. The State of Maharashtra is the one of the most developed States in India in terms of GDP and contributes to a quarter of the country's industrial output. However, the state is riddled with natural and climatic issues which effects the rural livelihoods in the State. The Government of Maharashtra has partnered with several corporate organisations (through CSR) and NGOs to launch initiatives such as Jalyukt Shivar and Gaalmukt Dharan/Gaayukt Shivar to address problems such as water and soil conservation in drought prone areas of the State.
- 1.2. Drawing inspiration from above initiatives, the Government of Maharashtra established Village Social Transformation Foundation (VSTF) as a section 8 company in 2016 focusing on transforming the villages with low Human Development Index (HDI) indicators through a multi-sectoral approach for improving the lives of the people.
- 1.3. The vision of VSTF is to bring about a holistic transformation in 1000 villages across 25 districts in Maharashtra with low HDI indicators. It has adopted an inclusive growth model to augment development across 16 indicators and 75 sub-indicators through partnerships with leading philanthropic organisations and corporate partners for an impactful convergence of the government schemes and evolving them to model villages.
- 1.4. Chief Minister's Rural Development Fellowship (CMRDF), a program launched in 2017 is significant in achieving the foundation's objective, through the deployment of fellows at the Gram Panchayat level in each district.
- 1.5. The roles and responsibilities of CMRDFs are multifaceted including but not limited to driving community participation, effective implementation of Central and State government schemes, and supporting villagers in increasing their living standards with the support from various state government departments, corporate organisations, and NGOs.
- 1.6. VSTF has reached out to Quality Council of India (QCI) for conducting an Impact Assessment Study across various Gram Panchayats (GPs) in 25 Districts. This includes impact and transformation brought by VSTF in the 48 GPs in 4 districts (Aurangabad, Akola, Amaravati, & Nagpur) with NGO partners and the rest 436 GPs through CMRDFs.
- 1.7. The proposal outlines the scope, objective and assessment approach which is to be undertaken for conducting an Impact Assessment Study (IAS) on the interventions of VSTF measuring the progress and impact created in 484 GPs.
- 1.8. To conduct the impact assessment, QCI and VSTF together shortlisted 10 thematic indicators to critically assess and evaluate the progress made in GPs of 25 districts. The assessment shall focus on the impact created through VSTF's interventions in improving the lives of the villagers at individual, household, and community level.

2. ABOUT QUALITY COUNCIL OF INDIA

- 2.1. **QCI** has been set up as a non-profit autonomous society registered under Societies Registration Act XXI of 1860 to establish an accreditation structure in the country and to spread quality movement in India by undertaking a National Quality Campaign.
- 2.2. QCI was established as an **autonomous non-profit organization** by the **Government of India** together with the **Indian Industry** represented by the three major industry associations: ASSOCHAM, CII and FICCI. The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (**DPIIT**), **Ministry of Commerce and Industry** is the nodal point for all matters connected to quality and QCI.
- 2.3. The Council was established to create a mechanism for **third party assessment** of products, services, and processes. In tune with the international best practices, it was envisaged that the Council will ensure that the quality of life of citizens is improved. It was therefore befitting that the Council was organized as an Independent Professional body with representation from the government and the industry, and with its own rules, powers, and functions strictly as per the Mo of the Society.
- 2.4. The **National Accreditation Board for Certification Bodies (NABCB)**, a constituent Board of QCI, is the apex national accreditation body which provides accreditation to Certification as well as Assessment Bodies in accordance with ISO Standards, international requirements / guidelines and NABCB Accreditation Criteria.
- 2.5. NABCB is internationally recognized and represents the interests of the Indian industry at international cooperation frameworks such as the International Accreditation Forum (**IAF**), International Laboratory Accreditation Cooperation (**ILAC**) and its recognized regional bodies such as the Asia Pacific Accreditation Cooperation (**APAC**).
- 2.6. Its objective is to promote acceptance of India's certifications and inspections internationally by becoming a signatory to the **Multilateral/Mutual Recognition Arrangements** (MLAs / MRAs) of the body after undergoing successful international peer evaluations. This confers worldwide equivalence to NABCB's accreditation schemes which ensures certificates granted by NABCB- accredited Conformity Assessment Bodies (CABs) are recognized/accepted all over the world.
- 2.7. The **National Accreditation Board for Testing and Calibration Laboratories (NABL)** is another constituent board of QCI that accredits laboratories across scopes. NABL is a Mutual Recognition Arrangement (**MRA**) signatory member of **APAC** (Asia Pacific Accreditation Cooperation) and **ILAC** (International Laboratory Accreditation Cooperation) since 2000. NABL in the year 2016 achieved the APAC MRA signatory status for Proficiency Testing Providers (PT) and Reference Material Producers (RMP) schemes along with extension in the existing fields of Testing, Calibration and Medical till December 2020.
- 2.8. In October 2019, NABL has also obtained ILAC MRA for Proficiency Testing Providers (PT) accreditation program (ISO/IEC 17043) in addition to existing Testing including Medical (ISO/IEC 17025 & ISO 15189) and Calibration (ISO/IEC 17025) programs.

3. OBJECTIVE

- 3.1. The overall objective of the Impact Assessment Study is to assess the interventions made by the VSTF in the selected 1000 low HDI villages and transforming them into model villages.
- 3.2. To assess the interventions undertaken and gauge the role of VSTF across 10 identified indicators in improving the lives of villagers across various levels viz., Individual, Household, and Community.
- 3.3. To evaluate the awareness and impact created by CMRDF fellows in bringing social transformation of villages through VSTF.

4. METHODOLOGY

- 4.1. The below-mentioned indicators and associated stakeholders are identified and finalised by QCI in consultation with VSTF. The assessment approach for each indicator is mentioned below:

SNO	INDICATORS	ASSESSMENT APPROACH
1.	AGRICULTURE	
1.1.	All farmers connected to at least 1 Farmers Group/FPO/GAT Sheti-ATMA	➤ Stakeholders – Gram Sarpanch/Sachiv, Farmers ➤ Interview - Gram Sarpanch/Sachiv on the status of Implementation of coverage of various Agricultural Schemes ➤ Survey/FGDs – Farmers on the coverage and challenges in availing Government schemes and to assess the impact created on their lives by these various Initiatives/schemes.
1.2.	Formation of FPC (Farmers Producer Company)	
1.3.	Cover each farmer in Central/State Agriculture Scheme (Crop Insurance, Crop Loan, Irrigation, etc.)	
2.	JAL YUKT SHIVAR / SOIL AND WATER CONSERVATION	
2.1.	Preparation of Water Budget	➤ Stakeholders – Gram Sarpanch/Sachiv, Farmers ➤ Interview - Gram Sarpanch/Sachiv on the status of various activities undertaken for soil/water conservation. ➤ Survey/FGDs – To assess the impact created in farmer's agricultural activities through these Soil/Water Conservation Initiatives.
2.2.	Preparation of DPR	
2.3.	Activities Planned & Executed (CB, CCT, CNB, LBS etc.)	
3.	RURAL HOUSING	
3.1.	Rural Housing	➤ Stakeholders – Beneficiaries under PMAY-G housing scheme. ➤ Survey/FGDs – Beneficiaries on the ease of application process and in receiving instalments at various stages.

4.	COMMUNITY INFRASTRUCTURE, ROADS, & MGNREGA	
4.1.	At least 1 Public Work/Year with 100 Labors Covered	➤ Stakeholders – Gram Sarpanch/Sachiv ➤ Interview - Gram Sarpanch/Sachiv on the status of implementation of various initiatives. ➤ Observational Study – Assessors to check the implementation at the community level on the existing infrastructure and interacting with Villagers on the same.
4.2.	Approach Pucca Roads having Roadside Plantation	
4.3.	Village Knowledge Centre/Library (in Existing Community Hall/Public Institution)	
4.4.	Internal Roads with Drainage	
4.5.	Institutional Buildings - Gram Panchayat, Anganwadi, School	
5.	DRINKING WATER AND SANITATION	
5.1.	100% Collection of Water Charges	➤ Stakeholders – Gram Sarpanch/Sachiv, Households ➤ Interview - Gram Sarpanch/Sachiv on the initiatives taken to strengthen the drinking water sources and its supply. ➤ Survey & Observational Study – To assess the availability of drinking water, and toilets at household and community levels.
5.2.	Strengthening of Drinking Water Sources	
5.3.	100% Coverage of IHHL/ODF	
5.4.	Availability of Toilets in Public Institutions	
6.	HEALTH	
6.1.	% Pregnant Women (PW) given a minimum of 4 or more Ante Natal Checkups (ANC)	➤ Stakeholders – Anganwadi workers, School Authority, Pregnant Women, & ANMs ➤ Observational Study – Pregnant Women available on the day of the assessment in Anganwadi Centres to assess awareness and number of ANCs undertaken. ➤ Interview – ANMs/Doctors in PHCs on the availability of Health Infrastructure (Human Resources, Electricity, Water Supply, Pharmacy, & Medical equipment etc.). The checklist shall be prepared and finalised in consultation with VSTF. ➤ Interview – Principal / Headmaster / Teachers / Villagers on the conduction of Health Camps in Govt. Schools and Community Centres.
6.2.	Health Infrastructure	
6.3.	Heath Camps once in a year in Villages and in Schools	
7.	EDUCATION	

7.1.	Conducive (Clean, Green and Well Maintained) school building	➤ Stakeholders – School Authorities, Students ➤ Interview – Principal/Headmaster on the maintenance of conducive school buildings and initiatives undertaken. It shall be counter checked with few students at the school through a random survey.
7.2.	Learning outcomes in children as per government norms.	➤ Interview – Teachers on various tools adopted in improving the learning outcomes amongst students. ➤ Observational Study - Measuring the learning outcomes in students from 5th Standard – 8th Standard on verbal, written and numerical abilities in one govt. school of each GP.
8.	ANIMAL HUSBANDRY & ALLIED ACTIVITIES	
8.1.	100% Land Less (LL) Farm Workers to be Covered under Poultry/Goat/Farming/Dairy/Fishery schemes	➤ Stakeholders – LL Farmers ➤ Survey/FGD – LL Farmers on the availability/awareness of related schemes on animal husbandry.
9.	WOMEN & CHILD DEVELOPMENT	
9.1.	School Nutrition Program	➤ Stakeholders – Anganwadi workers, Pregnant Women, School Authorities, & Students ➤ Interview - Anganwadi Workers to assess the availability and challenges in providing nutritious food for children and P&LM
9.2.	% of Pregnant & Lactating Mothers (P&LM) getting Nutritious Food	➤ Observational Study – P&LM on the quality of nutritious food provided. ➤ Interview - School Authority on the provision of mid-day meals as per guidelines of the Government of Maharashtra ➤ Observational Study – Students on the quality of meals provided in the schools for nutrition.
10.	SOCIAL BEHAVIOUR	
10.1.	Tobacco and Alcohol-Free GP	➤ Stakeholders – Villagers ➤ Observational Study – Villagers on their general opinion of the mentioned sub-indicators and their on-going practices.
10.2.	Eradication of Dowry Practice	
10.3.	Promotion of Nasbandi/Sterilization & Family Planning	

5. SAMPLING METHODOLOGY

- 5.1. Proportional Stratified Random Sampling is the sampling methodology adopted for this study. It involves the division of a population into smaller homogeneous subgroups known as strata. Random samples are then selected from each stratum, in proportion to the population.
- 5.2. In the State of Maharashtra, we are furthering with the assumption that similar programs/schemes/policies are implemented throughout the districts and GPs where VSTF has made interventions. Keeping this assumption in mind, it becomes imperative to represent each district where VSTF has intervened.
- 5.3. For the analysis of 10 indicators and 27 sub-indicators therein, which are applicable to all the 25 districts, the sampling is carried out as follows:
 - 5.3.1. The number of Gram Panchayats are categorized based on districts.
 - 5.3.2. The GPs only where VSTF has made interventions are accounted for each district.
 - 5.3.3. Further, sample size 'X' is calculated for the total number of GPs across 25 districts using Cochran's formula, with a 95% confidence level and 10% margin of error.
 - 5.3.4. 'X' is then multiplied based on the proportion of GPs within each district to have the district-wise sample.
 - 5.3.5. The GPs to be surveyed in each district are picked out randomly by a computer-generated code.
 - 5.3.6. Cochran's Formula:

$$\text{Infinite Population: } n = \frac{Z^2 * (P'(1 - P'))}{E^2}$$

$$\text{Finite Population: } n' = \frac{n}{1 + \frac{(Z^2 * (P'(1 - P')))}{(E^2 * N)}}$$

Where,

n = Sample size (unit) for infinite population

n' = Sample size (unit) for finite population or X or total number of GPs to survey

Z = (x-mean)/variance for 95% confidence interval, the Z value becomes 1.96

N = Population size (unit) is the total number of VSTF GPs in 25 districts

E = Acceptable sampling error/margin of error is 10%

P' = Proportion estimate taken as 0.5, to obtain the maximum sample size

- 5.3.7. The same method has been adopted to calculate the sample households for each GP.

5.4. The calculation of Sample Gram Panchayats has been depicted below:

5.4.1. With a 95% confidence interval and a 10% margin of error, the minimum required sample size calculated using Cochran's formula is 81 GPs. However, when distributed among districts, the ideal sample is arrived at 84 GPs.

5.4.2. The total number of VSTF GPs in 25 districts are 484 and the sample GPs to be assessed are 84.

5.4.3. For instance, within the Amravati district, there are total 34 VSTF GPs, the ideal sample of GPs to be assessed from this district are calculated as below:

5.4.3.1. Sample GPs for Amravati district: $(34/484) * 84 \approx 5.90$.

5.4.3.2. Upon nearest rounding, we shall select 6 GPs from the Amravati district.

5.4.4. An elaborative list of the 25 districts (where VSTF made intervention) and the district-wise sample number of GPs have been provided in Annexure – 1.

5.4.5. This method ensures that each district is represented proportionately in the study, thereby allowing for a more detailed and accurate assessment for the impact created by VSTF.

5.5. Similarly, the calculation of sample households has been depicted below:

5.5.1. With a 90% confidence level and a 10% margin of error, the calculated average sample size for each Gram Panchayat is 59 households (taking an average of 400 Households per GP). This sample households may vary depending on the actual number of households per GP.

5.5.2. This sample excludes a cross-section of specific stakeholders such as farmers and beneficiaries of the PMAY-G scheme, among others.

6. ASSESSOR TRAINING AND SELECTION

6.1. QCI through its pan India presence develops an exhaustive framework for training and selection of assessors who further shall be deployed in each district of all States/UTs for gathering citizen responses.

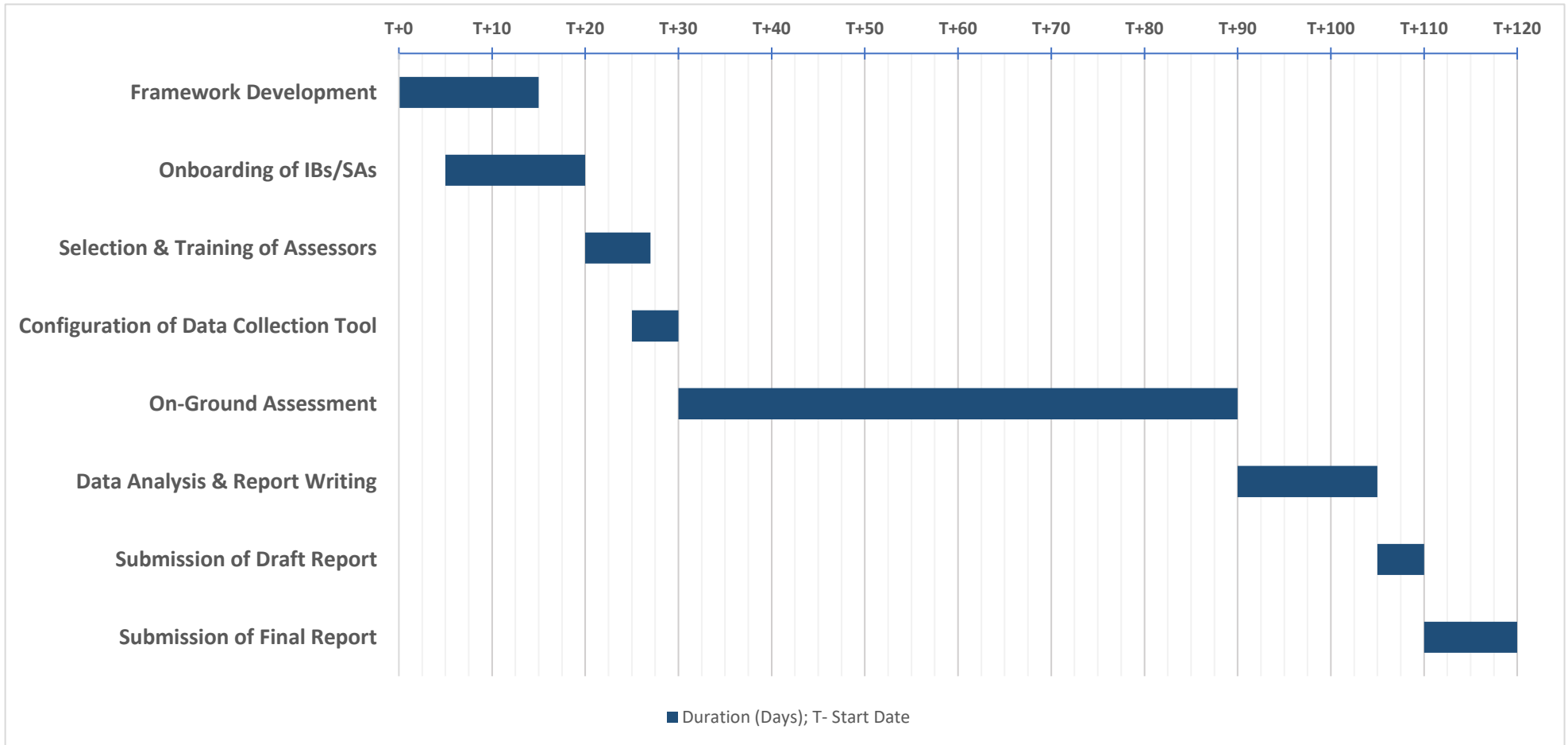
6.2. The assessors for this study shall be deployed through NABCB (National Accreditation Board for Certification Bodies, one of the boards under QCI) accredited **Inspection Bodies (IBs) / empanelled Survey Agencies (SAs)** of QCI basis their qualification. The assessors shall have a minimum 2-4 years of experience for conducting the assessment.

6.3. The evaluation of the assessors shall be done post virtual training provided by QCI on the relevant subject matter.

6.4. The selected assessors shall be well versed with the Marathi, Hindi, and English languages in order to conduct the on-ground assessment.

6.5. Orientation program for the assessors shall also be conducted to familiarize them with assessment process, criteria, relevant guidelines/protocols, & data collection tool for the assessment.

7. TIMELINE



IBs – Inspection Bodies; SAs – Survey Agencies

8. FINANCIALS

FINANCIALS						
A. CAPITAL EXPENDITURE						
Project Implementation Team						
SNO	Heads and Particulars	Unit	Unit cost	Qty.	Duration	Total (INR)
A.1	Project Lead	Man-month	150000	1	4	INR 6,00,000
A.2	Associate Managers	Man-month	90000	3	4	INR 10,80,000
A.3	Analysts	Man-month	60000	6	4	INR 14,40,000
A.4	Co-ordinators	Man-month	30000	5	4	INR 6,00,000
	Total Capital Expenditure (A)					INR 37,20,000
B. OPERATIONAL EXPENDITURE						
B1. Technology Cost						
SNO	Heads and Particulars	Unit	Unit cost	Qty.	Duration	Total (INR)
B1.1	Data Collection Tool					INR 1,00,000
	Total Technology Cost (B1)					INR 1,00,000
B2. On-Ground Assessment						
SNO	Heads and Particulars	Unit	Unit cost	Qty.	Duration	Total (INR)
B2.1	On Ground Assessor Cost	Man-day	2500	84	7	INR 14,70,000
	Total Cost of On-Ground Assessment (B2)					INR 14,70,000
Total Operational Expenditure B (B1+B2)						INR 15,70,000
Sub-Total (A+B)						INR 52,90,000
Administrative Cost (12%)						INR 6,34,800
Total						INR 59,24,800
GST @18%						INR 10,66,464
Grand Total (Total + GST)						INR 69,91,264

9. KEY DELIVERABLES

- 9.1. A detailed evaluation report basis the assessment of VSTF interventions in each indicator across 84 GPs in 25 districts.
- 9.2. Highlighting the areas for intervention and improvement in each indicator by identifying the strategic gaps in the interventions made by VSTF and actual implementation on-ground.
- 9.3. Progress of Districts – GP wise against each indicator and recommendations thereon for improving the implementation processes.

10. LIST OF REQUIREMENTS

- 10.1. A detailed list of Farmer Groups/ FPOs/ FPCs and the associated farmers list of the selected GPs.
- 10.2. A detailed list of farmers who are covered in Central/State agricultural scheme as mentioned in the sub-indicator (1.3.) of the selected GPs.
- 10.3. Beneficiaries under PMAY-G scheme of each selected GP.
- 10.4. List of Anganwadi Centres and PHCs in the selected GPs.
- 10.5. Details/ List of Health camps conducted in selected GPs of the previous year.
- 10.6. List of Government Schools in selected GPs and the contact details of the Principals/ Headmaster of the respective schools.
- 10.7. Detailed list of LL farmers covered under Poultry/ Goat/ Farming/ Dairy/ Fishery Schemes.
- 10.8. Updated list of number of Households in selected GPs.

11. ANNEXURE

ANNEXURE – 1

Sno	Name of the District	On-Ground Assessment in Sampled GPs
1.	Ahmednagar	1
2.	Akola	2
3.	Amravati	6
4.	Aurangabad	5
5.	Beed	5
6.	Buldhana	3
7.	Chandrapur	7
8.	Dhule	3
9.	Gadchiroli	4
10.	Hingoli	2
11.	Jalna	2
12.	Latur	5
13.	Nagpur	3
14.	Nanded	5
15.	Nandurbar	4
16.	Nashik	3
17.	Osmanabad	2
18.	Palghar	1
19.	Parbhani	3
20.	Pune	1
21.	Raigad	4
22.	Solapur	1
23.	Wardha	4
24.	Washim	1
25.	Yavatmal	7
	TOTAL	84